

Google sued

Google is sued by students for scanning their Google Accounts and not releasing details of what happened to their data. <http://dgit.in/SueGogl>



Startup Conclave

BITS Pilani's annual international startup conclave is back to fund new innovative startups. For more details and registration visit. <http://dgit.in/IntlConclave>

From the labs



HOW HYPERLOOP MIGHT FINALLY BECOME A REALITY

Transport is key to a civilisation's evolution as it facilitates the movement of resources and the faster the better. While we have conquered rail, road, water and air, it's time to conquer levitation transport - the fifth mode

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Although warp speed is the ultimate dream, it is best left to outer space where it would be practical. On Earth, however, we need a faster and cheaper mode of travel. Let's face it: roadways just don't figure in this discussion, railways are slow, planes are expensive (and limited because of needing space and infrastructure), and newer transport modes such as maglev have their own limitations. We're in the golden age of quantum physics, smashing atoms together and uncovering the secrets of the universe, but we still can't get from A to B as easily as we should.

All that's set to change soon, we hope. Just as subway trains cut down the time required to travel between places in a congested city, a new technology called hyperloop pods can drastically cut down the time and cost of travel between two cities. Think about it, you could travel from New Delhi To Mumbai in under an hour and a half! That's because hyperloop pods could have you travelling at speeds of 1,000 kmph. The same system could also be used within large cities to cut down the time required to get from one end of the city to another.

The tech

Like Maglev, the hyperloop system also uses electromagnetic propulsion, but while maglev uses electromagnetic propulsion for both thrust and levitation, the hyperloop system's pods float on a cushion of air, at least as originally envisioned. The pods run in enclosed tubes in a partial vacuum. They are highly energy efficient and are a carbon-free mode of transport. Their design is small in order to enable on-demand runs, thus minimising energy wastage. They can depart in mere 10 seconds intervals, and the system is not limited to terrain. It can run